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METHOD AND DEVICE FOR TREATING EYE DISEASE

Abstract

A device for lowering intraocular pressure is disclosed herein. In an example, the device includes a plate structure that enables aqueous humor to flow from a first end to a second end. The plate structure includes a first exposed surface opposite a second exposed surface. The first exposed surface includes a plurality of open cells. The second exposed surface includes a fluid pathway comprising a plurality of open channels. The plurality of open channels is configured in an intersecting grid pattern extending from the first end to the second end of the plate structure. Each of the plurality of open channels includes a channel ceiling, at least one channel wall, and an open-end located opposite the respective channel ceiling, thereby forming an open volume between the respective channel wall and the respective channel ceiling accessible through the respective open-end. The plate structure reduces intraocular pressure within the eye.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application claims the benefit as a continuation application of U.S. application Ser. No. 18/366,376, filed Aug. 7, 2023, which is a continuation application of U.S. application Ser. No. 16/254,765, filed Jan. 23, 2019, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,717,440, which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/620,922, filed Jan. 23, 2018 and U.S. Provisional Application No. 62,794,139, filed on Jan. 18, 2019. The disclosures of the above applications are incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND

[0002] Millions of individuals suffer from eye disease, specifically glaucoma. Most glaucoma patients are associated with abnormally high intraocular pressure (IOP) due to the patient's inability to drain excessive aqueous humor from the anterior chamber of the eye through the trabecular meshwork. If not reduced with adequate treatment, the high IOP would continuously damage the optic nerve as the disease progresses, leading to loss of vision or even total blindness. Current medications, surgeries, and implants have proven inadequate in lowering pressure within the eye or sustaining normal eye pressure over many years. Therefore, the need exists for new ways to alleviate IOP, thereby treating glaucoma.

BRIEF SUMMARY

[0003] Described herein is a device for lowering intraocular pressure, the device comprising: a plate structure comprising a first major exposed surface opposite a second major exposed surface, the plate structure formed from a multi-directional plate having a plate thickness ranging from about 1 nm to about 1,000 nm.

[0004] In other embodiments, the present invention includes a method of reducing intraocular pressure comprising: a) securing a treatment device to an eye, the treatment device comprising a plate structure having an upper surface opposite a lower surface, the plate structure formed from a multi-directional plate having a thickness ranging from about 1 nm to about 1,000 nm.

[0005] Other embodiments of the present invention include a device for lowering intraocular pressure, the device comprising: a plate structure comprising an upper surface opposite a lower surface, the lower surface comprising a plurality of open channels; wherein the plate structure has a height ranging from about 5 μm to about 20 μm as measured by the distance between the upper surface and the lower surface of the plate structure.

[0006] Other embodiments of the present invention include a device for lowering intraocular pressure, the device comprising: a first plate structure comprising an upper surface opposite a lower surface, the first plate structure formed from a first multi-directional plate having a plate thickness ranging from about 1 nm to about 1,000 nm; a second plate structure comprising an upper surface opposite a lower surface, the second plate structure formed from a second multi-directional plate having a plate thickness ranging from about 1 nm to about 1,000 nm.

[0007] Other embodiments of the present invention include a device for lowering intraocular pressure, the device comprising: a plate structure having a first major surface opposite a second

major surface, the plate structure comprising a multi-directional plate having a thickness ranging from about 1 nm to about 1,000 nm; and a penetrating element secured to the first major surface of the plate structure.

[0008] Other embodiments of the present invention include a method of reducing intraocular pressure comprising: implanting a treatment device in anterior portion of an eye, the treatment device comprising a plate structure formed from a multi-directional plate, whereby after implantation the a first end of the plate structure is located between sclera and conjunctiva of the eye.

[0009] Other embodiments of the present invention include a method of reducing intraocular pressure comprising: a) securing a treatment device to an eye, the treatment device comprising a plate structure comprising an uppermost surface opposite a lowermost surface; a plurality of open channels formed into the lower most surface; wherein the plate structure has a height ranging from about 5 μm to about 20 μm as measured by the distance between the uppermost surface and the lowermost surface of the plate structure.

[0010] Further areas of applicability of the present invention will become apparent from the detailed description provided hereinafter. It should be understood that the detailed description and specific examples, while indicating the preferred embodiment of the invention, are intended for purposes of illustration only and are not intended to limit the scope of the invention.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0011] The present invention will become more fully understood from the detailed description and the accompanying drawings, wherein:

[0012] FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a treatment device according to the present invention;

[0013] FIG. 2 is a top view of the treatment device of FIG. 1;

[0014] FIG. 3 is a close-up view of the treatment device according to section A identified in FIG. 1;

[0015] FIG. 4 is a cross-sectional view of the treatment device shown along line IV-IV in FIG. 3;

[0016] FIG. 5 is a perspective anterior view of an eye comprising the treatment device of the present invention implanted thereon;

[0017] FIG. 6 is a close-up view of a portion of an eye comprising the treatment device of the present invention implanted thereon;

[0018] FIG. 7 is a cross-sectional view the eye of FIG. 5 comprising the treatment device implanted there-on;

[0019] FIG. 8 is a close-up cross-sectional view the eye of FIG. 7 with the treatment device implanted there-on according to the present invention;

[0020] FIG. 9 is a perspective view of a treatment device according to another embodiment of the present invention;

[0021] FIG. 10 is a top view of the treatment device of FIG. 9;

[0022] FIG. 11 is a perspective anterior view of an eye comprising the treatment device of FIG. 9 implanted thereon;

[0023] FIG. 12 is a close-up view of a portion of an eye comprising the treatment device of FIG. 9 implanted thereon;

[0024] FIG. 13 is another close-up view of a portion of an eye comprising the treatment device of FIG. 9 implanted thereon;

[0025] FIG. 14 is a close-up cross-sectional view the eye of FIG. 11 with the treatment device of FIG. 9 implanted thereon;

[0026] FIG. 15 is a perspective view of a treatment device according to another embodiment of the present invention;

[0027] FIG. **16** is a close-up view of the treatment device according to section X identified in FIG. **15**;

[0028] FIG. **17** is a cross-sectional view of the treatment device shown along line XVII-XVII in FIG. **16**;

[0029] FIG. **18A** is a top view of a treatment device according to another embodiment of the present invention;

[0030] FIG. **18B** is a top view of a treatment device according to another embodiment of the present invention;

[0031] FIG. **18C** is a top view of a treatment device according to another embodiment of the present invention;

[0032] FIG. **18D** is a top view of a treatment device according to another embodiment of the present invention;

[0033] FIG. **18E** is a top view of a treatment device according to another embodiment of the present invention;

[0034] FIG. **18F** is a top view of a treatment device according to another embodiment of the present invention;

[0035] FIG. **19** is a perspective view of a treatment device according to another embodiment of the present invention;

[0036] FIG. **20** is a side view of the treatment device of FIG. **19**;

[0037] FIG. **21** is a perspective view of a treatment device according to another embodiment of the present invention; and

[0038] FIG. **22** is a side view of the treatment device of FIG. **21**.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0039] The following description of the preferred embodiment(s) is merely exemplary in nature and is in no way intended to limit the invention, its application, or uses.

[0040] As used throughout, ranges are used as shorthand for describing each and every value that is within the range. Any value within the range can be selected as the terminus of the range. In addition, all references cited herein are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties. In the event of a conflict in a definition in the present disclosure and that of a cited reference, the present disclosure controls.

[0041] The description of illustrative embodiments according to principles of the present invention is intended to be read in connection with the accompanying drawings, which are to be considered part of the entire written description. In the description of embodiments of the invention disclosed herein, any reference to direction or orientation is merely intended for convenience of description and is not intended in any way to limit the scope of the present invention. Relative terms such as “lower,” “upper,” “horizontal,” “vertical,” “above,” “below,” “up,” “down,” “top,” and “bottom” as well as derivatives thereof (e.g., “horizontally,” “downwardly,” “upwardly,” etc.) should be construed to refer to the orientation as then described or as shown in the drawing under discussion. These relative terms are for convenience of description only and do not require that the structure be constructed or operated in a particular orientation unless explicitly indicated as such.

[0042] Terms such as “attached,” “affixed,” “connected,” “coupled,” “interconnected,” and similar refer to a relationship wherein structures are secured or attached to one another either directly or indirectly through intervening structures, as well as both movable or rigid attachments or relationships, unless expressly described otherwise. Moreover, the features and benefits of the invention are illustrated by reference to the exemplified embodiments. Accordingly, the invention expressly should not be limited to such exemplary embodiments illustrating some possible non-limiting combination of features that may exist alone or in other combinations of features; the scope of the invention being defined by the claims appended hereto.

[0043] Unless otherwise specified, all percentages and amounts expressed herein and elsewhere in the specification should be understood to refer to percentages by weight. The amounts given are

based on the weight of the material. According to the present application, the term “about” means $\pm 5\%$ of the reference value. According to the present application, the term “substantially free” means less than about 0.1 wt. % based on the total of the referenced value.

[0044] A “subject” herein may be a human or a non-human animal, for example, but not by limitation, rodents such as mice, rats, hamsters, and guinea pigs; rabbits; dogs; cats; sheep; pigs; goats; cattle; horses; and non-human primates such as apes and monkeys, etc.

[0045] Referring to FIGS. 1-4, the present invention includes a treatment device **1** (also referred to as a “device”) for lowering intraocular pressure. Additionally, the device **1** of the present invention may provide improvements in treating eye disease specifically glaucoma.

[0046] The device **1** may comprise a plate structure **200** having a first major exposed surface **201** opposite a second major exposed surface **202** as well as a side surface **203** extending there-between. The plate structure **200** may comprise an uppermost surface **206** that is opposite a lowermost surface **207**. The first major exposed surface **201** may comprise the uppermost surface **206** of the plate structure **200**. The second major exposed surface **202** may comprise the lowermost surface **207** of the plate structure **200**.

[0047] The overall shape of first major exposed surface **201** and second major exposed surface **202** of the plate structure **200** may be defined by the side surface **203**. The side surface **203** may define a perimeter of the first and second major exposed surfaces **201**, **202**. The overall shape of the plate structure may be selected from a variety of geometries. Non-limiting examples of such geometries include polygonal shape, circular shape, mushroom shape, elliptic shape, oblong shape, oval shape, amoeba shape, or butterfly shape with lateral wings.

[0048] The plate structure **200** may have a plate structure height $H_{\text{sub.1}}$, which is the overall distance measured between the uppermost surface **206** and the lowermost surface **207** of the plate structure **200**. The plate structure height H_i may range from about 5 μm to about 20 μm —including all distances and sub-ranges there-between.

[0049] The plate structure **200** may be at least partially formed from a multi-directional plate **210** (also referred to as the “plate” **210**). The plate **210** is a three-dimensional body. The plate **210** may comprise a first major surface **211** that is opposite a second major surface **212** and a side surface **213** that extends between the first and second major surfaces **211**, **212**. When viewed with the naked eye, the first major surface **211** of the plate **210** may be substantially continuous and appear smooth. When viewed with the naked eye, the second major surface **212** of the plate **210** may be substantially continuous and appear smooth. The plate **210** may be translucent. The plate **210** may be light-transmissive.

[0050] The plate **210** may have a thickness T as measured by the distance extending between the adjacent-most portions of the first major surface **211** and the second major surface **212** of the plate **210** in an orthogonal direction to the first and second major surfaces **211**, **212**. The thickness T may range from about 1 nm to about 1,000 nm—including all thicknesses and sub-ranges there-between. In some embodiments, the thickness T may range from about 50 nm to about 500 nm—including all thicknesses and sub-ranges there-between. In some embodiments, the thickness T may range from about 100 nm to about 400 nm—including all thicknesses and sub-ranges there-between. In some embodiments, the thickness T may range from about 100 nm to about 250 nm—including all thicknesses and sub-ranges there-between. In some embodiments, the thickness T may range from about 250 nm to about 500 nm—including all thicknesses and sub-ranges there-between. In some embodiments, the thickness T may range from about 300 nm to about 550 nm—including all thicknesses and sub-ranges there-between.

[0051] The multi-directional plate **210** may be a single layer that is patterned in three-dimensional space, thereby forming the multi-directional geometry of the multi-directional plate **210**. While the geometry of the multi-directional plate **210** may result in the overall plate structure **200** having a height H as greater as 20 μm , the thickness of the multi-directional plate **210**—i.e., the thickness of the single layer that is patterned into the multi-directional plate **210**—remains within the

aforementioned thickness T range of 1 nm to 1,000 nm.

[0052] In some embodiments, the first major surface **211** of the plate **210** may at least partially make up the first exposed major surface **201** of the plate structure **200**. Stated otherwise, the first exposed major surface **201** of the plate structure **200** may at least partially comprise the first major surface **211** of the plate **210**. In some embodiments, the second major surface **212** of the plate **210** may at least partially make up the second exposed major surface **202** of the plate structure **200**. Stated otherwise, the second exposed major surface **202** of the plate structure **200** may at least partially comprise the second major surface **212** of the plate **210**. In some embodiments, the side surface **213** of the plate **210** may at least partially make up the side surface **203** of the plate structure **200**. Stated otherwise, the side surface **203** of the plate structure **200** may at least partially comprise the side surface **213** of the plate **210**.

[0053] Referring now to FIG. 4 in particular, the first major exposed surface **201** of the plate structure **200** may comprise a first topography **204**. The first topography **204** may be created by the first major surface **211** of the plate **210** as a result of the multi-directional patterned geometry of the multi-directional plate **210**. The first topography **204** may comprise surface features that are formed into the uppermost surface **206** of the plate structure **200**, whereby the surface features extend from the uppermost surface **206** in a direction toward the lowermost surface **207** of the plate structure **200** and terminate at a floor **224**—as discussed in greater detail herein.

[0054] The plate structure **200** may further comprise a second topography **205**. The second topography **205** may be created by the second major surface **212** of the plate **210** as a result of the multi-directional patterned geometry of the multi-directional plate **210**. The second topography **205** may comprise surface features that are formed into the lowermost surface **207** of the plate structure **200**, whereby the surface features extend from the lowermost surface **207** in a direction toward the uppermost surface **206** of the plate structure **200** and terminate at a ceiling **234**—as discussed in greater detail herein.

[0055] The surface features of the first topography **204** and/or second topography **205** may comprise one or more cells **222**. As described in greater detail herein, the cells **222** may be open cells. In other embodiments, the surface features of the first topography **204** and/or second topography **205** may comprise one or more channels **232**. As described in greater detail herein, the channels **232** may be open channels.

[0056] Although not limited to, the foregoing discussion will reference the first topography **204** comprising one or more cells **222** and the second topography **205** comprising one or more channels **232**. Although not pictured, other embodiments of the present invention include that the first topography **204** may comprise one or more channels **232** and the second topography **205** may comprise one or more cells **222**.

[0057] Each cell **222** may comprise a cell floor **224** and at least one cell wall **226**. The cell wall **226** may circumscribe the cell floor **224**. The cell walls **226** may extend downward from the uppermost surface **206** of the plate structure **200** to the cell floor **224** in a direction toward the lowermost surface **207** of the plate structure **200**, whereby the cell walls **226** may terminate at the cell floor **224**. The cell walls **226** may extend upward from the cell floor **224** in a direction toward the uppermost surface **206** of the plate structure **200**, whereby the cell walls **226** may terminate at the uppermost surface **206** of the plate structure **200**.

[0058] Each of the cells **222** may comprise a cell axis C.sub.A-C.sub.A. The cell axis C.sub.A-C.sub.A is oriented substantially normal to the floor surface **224**. The cell wall surface **226** may be oriented about the cell axis C.sub.A-C.sub.A.

[0059] The cell walls **226** may form a perimeter of each cell **222**. Although not pictured, the cell walls **226** may be a single continuous wall surface, whereby the cell **222** forms a cylindrical shape. Non-limiting examples of cylindrical shapes include circular cylinders as well as elliptical cylinders. As demonstrated by FIG. 3, other embodiments provide that each cell **222** may be formed from a plurality of cell walls **226** that intersect each other to form a polygonal perimeter. In

such embodiments, although not limited to, the number of cell walls **226** that form a polygonal perimeter may range from 3 to 20 sides—including all sides and sub-ranges there-between. In the embodiment exemplified in FIG. 3, each cell **222** is formed from six intersecting cell walls **226** that form a hexagonal perimeter.

[0060] Collectively, the uppermost surface **206**, the cell wall **226**, and the cell floor **224** may form at least a portion of the first major exposed surface **201** of the plate structure **200**. The first major surface **211** of the plate **210** may comprise the first major exposed surface **201** of the plate structure **200**. Stated otherwise, the first major surface **211** of the plate **210** may comprise the uppermost surface **206** as well as the cell wall **226** and the cell floor **224** formed by the first topography **204**.

[0061] Each cell **222** may further comprise an open-end **228** that is located opposite the cell floor **224**. The cell axis C.sub.A-C.sub.A may intersect the open-end **228**. The open-end **228** may be a fluid pathway that provides access the open volume of the cell **222** located between the cell wall surface **226** and the floor surface **224**. Stated otherwise, each of the cells **222** may be open (also referred to as “open-ended”) such that no ceiling exists opposite the cell floor **224**, which would otherwise close the cell **222** and encapsulate the open volume of the cell **222**.

[0062] Each of the cells **222** may be isolated from each other by their respective cell walls **226**, such that the open volume of each cell **222** is not in fluid communication with other open-volumes of other cells **222**.

[0063] The first topography **204** may be formed by the multi-directional nature of the multi-directional plate **210**. As a result, the dimensions of the plate structure **200**—specifically the dimensions of the first topography **204**, may be determined with respect to the thickness T of the plate **210**.

[0064] For each cell **222**, the cell floor **224** may be offset from the uppermost surface **206** of the plate structure **200** by a first distance D₁ (also referred to herein as “cell depth”). Although not limited to, the offset between the uppermost surface **206** and the floor surface **224** may be referred to as a “vertical offset” or “vertically offset.” The first distance D₁ is a non-zero value. The first distance D₁ may be equal to the difference between the first height H₂ of the plate structure **200** and the thickness T of the plate **210**—whereby the first distance D₁ is calculated according to the following formula:

$$[00001] D_1 = H_2 - T$$

[0065] For each cell **222**, the cell floor **224** may be offset from the lowermost surface **207** by a second distance D.sub.2. Although not limited to, the offset between the lowermost surface **207** and the floor surface **224** may be referred to as a “vertical offset” or “vertically offset.” The second distance D.sub.2 is a non-zero value. The second distance D.sub.2 may be substantially equal to the thickness T of the plate **210**. The summation of the first distance D.sub.1 and the second distance D.sub.2 may be substantially equal to the first height H.sub.2.

[0066] Referring now to FIGS. 3 and 4, each cell **222** may have a cell length L.sub.2 and a cell width W.sub.2 as measured by the distance extending between opposite cell walls **226** within each cell **222**. In some embodiments, the cell length L.sub.2 and the cell width W.sub.2 may be equal. In other embodiments, the cell length L.sub.2 and the cell width W.sub.2 may be different. The cell length L.sub.2 may range from about 10 μm to about 110 μm—including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between. In some embodiments, the cell length L.sub.2 may range from about 30 μm to about 70 μm preferably from about 40 μm to about 60 μm—including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between. The cell width W.sub.2 may range from about 10 μm to about 110 μm—including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between. In some embodiments, the cell width W.sub.2 may range from about 30 μm to about 70 μm preferably from about 40 μm to about 60 μm—including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between.

[0067] Each channel **232** may be formed by a channel ceiling **234** and at least one channel wall **236**. The channel walls **236** may extend downward from the channel ceiling **234** and in a direction toward the lowermost surface **207** of the plate structure **200**, whereby the channel walls **236**

terminate at the lowermost surface **207** of the plate structure **200**. The channel walls **236** may extend upward from the lowermost surface **207** in a direction toward the channel ceiling **234**, whereby the channel walls **236** may terminate at the channel ceiling **234**.

[0068] Collectively, the lowermost surface **207**, the channel wall **236**, and the channel ceiling **234** may form at least a portion of the second major exposed surface **202** of the plate structure **200**. The second major surface **212** of the plate **210** may comprise the second major exposed surface **202** of the plate structure **200**. Stated otherwise, the second major surface **212** of the plate **210** may comprise the lower surface **207** as well as the channel wall **236** and the channel floor **234** formed by the second topography **205**.

[0069] Each channel **232** may further comprise an open-end **238** that is located opposite the channel ceiling **234**. The open-end **238** may be a fluid pathway that provides access the open volume of the channel **232** located between the channel walls **236** and the channel ceiling **234**. Stated otherwise, each of the channels **232** may be open (also referred to as “open-ended”) such that no floor exists opposite the channel ceiling **234**, thereby closing the channel **232** or encapsulating the channel-volume that is created by the channel walls **236** and channel floors **234**.

[0070] A plurality of intersecting channels **234** may be present on the second major surface **202** of the plate structure **200**, thereby forming a network of channels. Each of the channels in the network may be in fluid communication with each other, thereby allowing a fluid to flow along the second major surface **202** of the plate structure **200** via the channels **232**.

[0071] The second topography **205** of the present invention may be formed by the multi-directional nature of the multi-directional plate **210**. As a result, the dimensions of the plate structure **200** specifically the dimensions of the second topography **205**, may be determined with respect to the thickness **T** of the plate **210**.

[0072] For each channel **232**, the channel ceiling **234** may be offset from the lowermost surface **207** of the plate structure **200** by a third distance **D.sub.3** (also referred to herein as “channel depth”). Although not limited to, the offset between the lowermost surface **207** and the channel ceiling **234** may be referred to as a “vertical offset” or “vertically offset.” The third distance **D.sub.3** is a non-zero value. The third distance **D.sub.3** may be equal to the difference between the first height **H.sub.2** of the plate structure **200** and the thickness **T** of the plate **210**—whereby the third distance **D.sub.3** is calculated according to the following formula:

$$[00002] D_3 = H_2 - T$$

[0073] For each channel **232**, the channel ceiling **234** may be offset from the uppermost surface **206** by a fourth distance **D.sub.4**. Although not limited to, the offset between the uppermost surface **206** and the channel ceiling **234** may be referred to as a “vertical offset” or “vertically offset.” The fourth distance **D.sub.4** is a non-zero value. The fourth distance **D4** may be substantially equal to the thickness **T** of the plate **210**. The summation of the third distance **D3** and the fourth distance **D.sub.4** may be substantially equal to the first height **H.sub.2**.

[0074] Each channel **232** may have a channel length and a channel width **W.sub.1**. The channel width **W.sub.1** is measured by the distance extending between opposite channel walls **236** within each channel **222**. The channel length is measured by the distance extending along the channel **232** between intersecting other channels **232**. In some embodiments, the channel length is greater than the channel width **W.sub.1**. The channel length may range from about 10 μm to about 110 μm —including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between. In some embodiments, the channel length may range from about 30 μm to about 70 μm preferably from about 40 μm to about 60 μm —including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between. The channel width **W.sub.1** may range from about 10 μm to about 40 μm —including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between. In a preferred embodiment, the channel width **W.sub.1** may range from about 10 μm to about 15 μm —including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between.

[0075] It has been discovered that a channel depth and channel width **W.sub.1** of about 10 μm to 15 μm provides for normal physiologic flow of aqueous humor along the plate structure **200**. The flow

rate of the aqueous humor along such plate may range from about 1.75 $\mu\text{L}/\text{min}$ to about 2.75 $\mu\text{L}/\text{min}$ preferably about 2 $\mu\text{L}/\text{min}$ to about 2.5 $\mu\text{L}/\text{min}$ including all rates and sub-ranges there-between.

[0076] In some embodiments, the plate **210** and resulting plate structure **200** may be formed from a variety of materials. The materials forming the plate are preferably biocompatible materials. As used herein, the term “biocompatibility” refers to compatibility with living tissue or a living system by not being toxic, injurious, or physiologically reactive and not causing immunological rejection. Non-limiting examples of materials that form the plate **210** include ceramic materials, polymeric materials, metallic materials, and composite materials thereof.

[0077] Non-limiting examples of ceramic materials include alumina (Al.sub.2O.sub.3), silicon nitride (Si.sub.xN.sub.y), silica (SiO.sub.2), hafnium oxide (HfO.sub.2), titanium nitride (TiN.sub.x), titanium carbide (TiC), derivative thereof, and a combination thereof. In a preferred embodiment, the ceramic material includes alumina. In another preferred embodiment, the ceramic material includes silicon nitride. Non-limiting examples of metallic material include platinum, gold, or tungsten.

[0078] The plate **210**—and resulting plate structure **200**—may have a higher flexural stiffness as compared to planar films. For example, plate **210** may have the same thickness as planar structures and have a much higher spring constant when used as cantilevers and/or doubly clamped beams. Similarly, plate **210** may have the same spring constant as planar structures and can be significantly thinner. For example, plate **210** of the present invention may be at least about 20 times thinner, at least about 15 times thinner, at least about 10 times thinner, or at least about 5 times thinner than planar structures having the same flexural stiffness.

[0079] The plate **210** of the present invention may be flexible. According to the present invention, the term “flexible” refers to the plate **210** being capable of being deformed without any or a substantial amount of fracture or permanent deformation—also referred to as having shape-recovery. Specifically, the flexibility of the plate **210** may provide that the first and second major surfaces **211**, **212** can be folded at least 90° without fracture to the plate **210**. In some embodiments, the plate **210** flexibility may provide that the first and second major surfaces **211**, **212** can be folded up to 180° without fracture to the plate **210**. Similarly, the flexibility of the plate structure **200** may provide that the first and second exposed major surfaces **201**, **202** can be folded at least 90° without fracture to the plate structure **200**. In some embodiments, the flexibility of the plate structure **200** may provide that the first and second exposed major surfaces **201**, **202** can be folded up to 180° without fracture to the plate structure **200**.

[0080] Therefore, the present invention provides for a plate **210**—and resulting plate structure **200** that may be formed entirely from a metal and/or ceramic material that may also be flexible (i.e., capable of being folded up to 180° , preferably at least 90° , without fracture).

[0081] In some embodiments, plate structure **200** may be ultralight. The term “ultralight” refers to the plate structure **200** and corresponding plate **210** having a relative density on the order of about $10.\text{sup.}-4$. The plate structure **200** may also have an areal density on the order of 100 milligrams per square meter. For example, the plate structure **200** may have an areal density between about 10 $\text{mg/m}.\text{sup.2}$ and about 1000 $\text{mg/m}.\text{sup.2}$ —including all densities and sub-ranges there-between.

[0082] Referring now to FIGS. 1 and 2, the device **1** may comprise a plate structure **200** that extends along a longitudinal axis A-A. The plate structure **200** may further comprise a proximal end **208** opposite a distal end **209**, whereby the longitudinal axis A-A intersects both the proximal end **208** and distal end **209** of the plate structure **200**. The plate structure **200** may have a plate structure length $L.\text{sub.PS}$ that spans the distance from the proximal end **208** to the distal end **209** of the plate structure **200**. The plate structure length $L.\text{sub.PS}$ may range from about 10 mm to about 24 mm—including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between. In a preferred embodiment, the plate structure length $L.\text{sub.PS}$ may be about 17 mm.

[0083] The plate structure **200** may further comprise a main body portion **240** and an extension

portion **250**. The main body portion **240** may comprise a proximal end **241** that is opposite a distal end **242**. The extension portion **250** may comprise a proximal end **251** that is opposite a distal end **252**. The proximal end **251** of the extension portion **250** may extend from the distal end **242** of the main body portion **240**. The proximal end **241** of the main body portion **240** may overlap with the proximal end **208** of the plate structure **200**. The distal end **252** of the extension portion **250** may overlap with the distal end **209** of the plate structure **200**.

[0084] The main body portion **240** may comprise a first major surface **243** that is opposite a second major surface **244**. The first major exposed surface **201** of the plate structure **200** may comprise the first major surface **243** of the main body portion **240**. The second major exposed surface **202** of the plate structure **200** may comprise the second major surface **244** of the main body portion **240**.

[0085] The main body portion **240** may extend a main body length $L_{sub.MB}$ that spans the distance from the proximal end **241** to the distal end **242** of the main body portion **240**. The main body length $L_{sub.MB}$ may range from about 8 mm to about 16 mm—including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between. In a preferred embodiment, the main body length $L_{sub.MB}$ may be about 12 mm.

[0086] The main body portion **240** may have a main body width $W_{sub.MB}$ that as measured by the distance spanning the direction extending normal to the longitudinal axis A-A. The main body width $W_{sub.MB}$ may range from about 4 mm to about 8 mm—including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between. In a preferred embodiment, the main body width $W_{sub.MB}$ may be about 6 mm.

[0087] The extension portion **250** may comprise a first major surface **253** that is opposite a second major surface **254**. The first major exposed surface **201** of the plate structure **200** may comprise the first major surface **253** of the extension portion **250**. The second major exposed surface **202** of the plate structure **200** may comprise the second major surface **254** of the extension portion **250**.

[0088] The extension portion **250** may extend an extension length $L_{sub.E}$ that spans the distance from the proximal end **251** to the distal end **252** of the extension portion **250**. The extension length $L_{sub.E}$ may range from about 1 mm to about 4 mm—including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between. In a preferred embodiment, the extension length $L_{sub.E}$ may be about 2 mm.

[0089] The extension portion **250** may have an extension width $W_{sub.E}$ that as measured by the distance spanning the direction extending normal to the longitudinal axis A-A. The extension width $W_{sub.E}$ may range from about 1.0 mm to about 6.0 mm—including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between. In a preferred embodiment, the extension width $W_{sub.E}$ may be about 2.6 mm.

[0090] In some embodiments, the main body length $L_{sub.MB}$ and the extension length $L_{sub.E}$ may be equal. In other embodiments, the main body length $L_{sub.MB}$ and the extension length $L_{sub.E}$ may be different. In some embodiments, a ratio of the main body length $L_{sub.MB}$ to the extension length $L_{sub.E}$ may range from about 1:1 to about 5:1—including all ratios and sub-ranges there-between. In some embodiments, the ratio of the main body length $L_{sub.MB}$ to the extension length $L_{sub.E}$ is greater than 1:1. In some embodiments, the ratio of the main body length $L_{sub.MB}$ to the extension length $L_{sub.E}$ may range from about 3:1 to about 5:1—including all ratios and sub-ranges there-between.

[0091] In some embodiments, the main body width $W_{sub.MB}$ and the extension width $W_{sub.E}$ may be equal. In other embodiments, the main body width $W_{sub.MB}$ and the extension width $W_{sub.E}$ may be different. In other embodiments, the main body width $W_{sub.MB}$ may be greater than the extension width $W_{sub.E}$. In some embodiments, a ratio of the main body width $W_{sub.MB}$ to the extension width $W_{sub.E}$ may range from about 1:1 to about 4:1—including all ratios and sub-ranges there-between. In some embodiments, a ratio of the main body width $W_{sub.MB}$ to the extension width $W_{sub.E}$ may range from about 1.1:1 to about 4:1—including all ratios and sub-ranges there-between. In some embodiments, the ratio of the main body width $W_{sub.MB}$ to the extension width $W_{sub.E}$ may range from about 1.5:1 to about 3:1—including all ratios and sub-ranges there-between.

[0092] The first major surface **253** of the extension portion **250** may be substantially coplanar with the first major surface **243** of the main body portion **240**. The second major surface **254** of the extension portion **250** may be substantially coplanar with the second major surface **244** of the main body portion **240**.

[0093] The main body portion **240** may have a height, as measured by the distance between the first and second major surfaces **243**, **244** of the main body portion **240**, that is substantially equal to the first height H.sub.1 of the plate structure **200**. The extension portion **250** may have a height, as measured by the distance between the first and second major surfaces **243**, **244** of the extension portion **250**, that is substantially equal to the first height H.sub.1 of the plate structure **200**.

[0094] Referring now to FIGS. 5-8, the treatment device **1** of the present invention may be positioned in contact with an eye **900** for the treatment of an eye disease. Non-limiting examples of such eye disease include glaucoma. The eye **900** generally comprises outer tissue comprising the sclera **913**, cornea **910**, conjunctiva **950**, and limbus. Within the eye **900**, two chambers exist that include the posterior cavity **995** which is located behind lens **930** of the eye **900**, and the anterior chamber **990** which is located in front of the lens **930** of the eye **900**. The posterior cavity **995** houses vitreous humor and the anterior chamber **990** houses aqueous humor.

[0095] As described herein, the eye **900** comprises a front region **901** and a rear region **902**, whereby a boundary **903** generally exists between the front region **901** and the rear region **902**. The front region **901** of the eye **900** comprises the cornea **910**, iris **911**, pupil **912**, conjunctiva tissue **950**, ciliary body **915** and the lens **930**, a portion of the sclera **913**, as well as encompasses the anterior chamber **990** of the eye **900**. The front region **901** may further comprise a limbal region **980**, a corneo-limbal region **982**, and anterior scleral region **950**.

[0096] The rear region **902** comprises eye muscle tissue **920** (also referred to as “eye muscles”), a portion of the sclera **913**, the optic nerve **942**, the retina **941**, as well as encompasses the posterior cavity **995** of the eye **900**. The eye muscles **920** are present in the orbital cavity of a subject. The eye muscles **920** comprise the superior rectus muscle **921** located at a top portion of the eye **900**, the inferior rectus muscle **922** located at a bottom portion of the eye **900**, and the lateral rectus muscle **923** located between the superior rectus muscle **921** and the inferior rectus muscle **922**.

[0097] The present invention includes a method for treating eye disease such as glaucoma by lowering intraocular pressure of a subject using the treatment device **1**. Specifically, the treatment device **1** provides a fluid pathway for excess fluid present in either the anterior chamber **990** and/or the posterior cavity **995** to exit the eye **900**. In a preferred embodiment, the treatment device **1** lowers intraocular pressure of the subject by providing a fluid pathway for excess fluid to exit the anterior chamber **990** to a location exterior the sclera **913**.

[0098] The term “excess fluid” refers to an additional volume of aqueous humor present in the anterior chamber **990** that raises the intraocular pressure to be greater than a normal intraocular pressure for a healthy eye. For eyes **900** that cannot release such excess fluid, the increased intraocular pressure is a factor contributing to blindness in glaucoma patients. Therefore, providing a fluid pathway for the excess fluid to be expelled from the anterior chamber **990** of the eye **900** can help reduce intraocular pressure, thereby helping treat glaucoma.

[0099] In non-limiting embodiments, the methods described herein may be suitable for treating any types of ophthalmic condition related to intraocular pressure. Non-limiting examples of ophthalmic condition include primary open-angle glaucoma, normal-tension glaucoma, ocular hypertension, primary angle closure glaucoma, congenital and juvenile glaucoma, and secondary glaucomas, including exfoliative, uveitic, neovascular, pigmentary and other secondary glaucomas. In particular, the ophthalmic condition include glaucoma and all subtypes of glaucoma.

[0100] The treatment device **1** of the present invention provides such fluid pathway for excess fluid to exit the eye **900**. Specifically, the treatment device **1** may be implanted onto the eye **900** such that it creates a fluid pathway from the anterior chamber **990** to the exterior of the sclera **913** to form a subconjunctival bleb. The term “subconjunctival bleb” refers to a fluid pocket containing

aqueous humor, wherein the fluid pocket is located between conjunctiva and sclera tissues. Once on the exterior surface of the sclera **913**, the excess fluid can be carried away from the eye **900** by absorption into surrounding tissue in the subject.

[0101] In particular, the treatment device **1** may be implanted onto the eye **900** such that the plate structure **200** is located between the sclera **913** and conjunctiva **950** tissue. The extension portion **250** may extend from the main body portion **240** through the sclera **913** and into the anterior chamber **990** of the eye **900** such that the distal end **209** of the plate structure **200** is located within the anterior chamber **990**. Under this configuration, the plate structure **200** may function as an external reservoir for the excess fluid until it is absorbed by the surrounding tissue of the subject. In certain embodiments, prior to implanting the treatment device **1**, the plate structure **200** may be sterilized to minimize postoperative complications.

[0102] The extension portion **250** may extend from the main body portion **240** through the sclera **913** and into the anterior chamber **990** of the eye **900** (as shown in the FIGS) or may extend from the main body portion **240** through the sclera **913** and into the posterior cavity **989** of the anterior chamber **990** of the eye **900**. The treatment device **1** may be implanted such that the extension portion **250** extends through the limbal region **980**, the corneal limbal region **981**, or the anterior scleral region **982**.

[0103] In such embodiments, the first and/or second topographies **204**, **205** of the plate structure **200** may provide the fluid pathway for the excess fluid to exit the anterior chamber **990** of the eye **900**, thereby relieving excess intraocular pressure.

[0104] The treatment device **1** may be implanted such that the treatment device **1** is secured to the eye **900**. In some embodiments, the treatment device **1** may be implanted between the conjunctiva **950** and the sclera **913**. In a non-limiting example, a conjunctival incision can be created to allow adequate exposure for insertion of the treatment device **1**. In a non-limiting embodiment, the treatment device **1** may be secured any eye **900** by suture or extending through the plate structure **200** to the sclera **913**.

[0105] Once implanted, the first major exposed surface **201** of the plate structure **200** may face the sclera **913** and the second major exposed surface **202** of the plate structure **200** may face the conjunctiva **950**. In such embodiments, the first major exposed surface **201** of the plate structure **200** may contact the sclera **913** and the second major exposed surface **202** of the plate structure **200** may contact the conjunctiva **950**. In other embodiments, the treatment device **1** may be implanted such that the first major exposed surface **201** of the plate structure **200** faces the conjunctiva **950** and the second major exposed surface **202** of the plate structure **200** faces the sclera **913**. In such embodiments, the first major exposed surface **201** of the plate structure **200** may contact the conjunctiva **950** and the second major exposed surface **202** of the plate structure **200** may contact the sclera **913**.

[0106] In other embodiments, the treatment device **1** may comprise plate structure **200** that extends from the exterior surface of the sclera **913**, through the sclera **913**, and into the anterior chamber **990** of the eye **900** whereby the plate structure **200** itself provides a fluid pathway for excess fluid to exit from within the eye **900**. In such embodiments, the excess intraocular fluid may travel along via the treatment device **1** and exit the eye **900** by capillary action.

[0107] According to the present invention, the plate structure **200** having the previously discussed thickness **T** and material properties allows for placement of the treatment device **1** at least partially within the front region **901** of the eye **900**. In some embodiments, the treatment device **1** may be implanted entirely within the front region **901** of the eye **900** herein referred to as “forward placement.” Such forward placement may allow at least a portion of the treatment device **1** to be present on the anterior portion **901** of the eye **900**—as discussed further herein. Additionally, such forward-placement of the treatment device **1** may allow a less invasive implant procedure—as compared to previous implant devices. Additionally, such forward placement may also provide greater comfort to the subject. Furthermore, the translucent appearance of the plate structure **200**

may provide that the treatment device **1** is at least partially implanted within the front region **901** of the eye without the treatment device from being readily perceivable when a subject's eye **900** with viewing a naked eye.

[0108] Referring to FIGS. **5** and **6**, the treatment device **1** may be implanted onto an eye **900** such that the treatment device **1** is located at least partially between superior rectus muscle **921** and lateral rectus muscle **923**. In such embodiments, the treatment device **1** may be located entirely between the superior rectus muscle **921** and lateral rectus muscle **923** such that there is no overlap with the superior rectus muscle **921** or the lateral rectus muscle **923**. In other embodiments, the treatment device **1** may be implanted onto an eye **900** such that the treatment device **1** is located at least partially between the inferior rectus muscle **922** and the lateral rectus muscle **923**. In such embodiments, the treatment device **1** may be located entirely between the inferior rectus muscle **922** and lateral rectus muscle **923** such that there is no overlap with the inferior rectus muscle **923** or the lateral rectus muscle **923**.

[0109] Referring now to FIGS. **18A-18F** concurrently, multiple treatment devices **1d-1i** are illustrated in accordance with another embodiment of the present invention. The devices **1d**, **1e**, **1f**, **1g**, **1h**, **1i** are similar to the device **1** except as described herein below. The description of the device **1** above generally applies to the devices **1d**, **1e**, **1f**, **1g**, **1h**, **1i** described below except with regard to the differences specifically noted below. A similar numbering scheme will be used for the devices **1d**, **1e**, **1f**, **1g**, **1h**, **1i** as with the device **1** except that a suffix of d, e, f, g, h, and i will be used.

[0110] As stated, the overall shape of the plate structure **200**, **200d**, **200e**, **200f**, **200g**, **200h**, **200i** may be selected from a variety of geometries. Non-limiting examples of such geometries include polygonal shape, circular shape, mushroom shape, elliptic shape, oblong shape, oval shape, amoeba shape, or butterfly shape with lateral wings.

[0111] In a non-limiting embodiment, the treatment device **1d-1i**, may comprise an extension portion **250d**, **250e**, **250f**, **250g**, **250h**, **250i** that is polygonal. According to these embodiments, the extension portion **250d**, **250e**, **250f**, **250g**, **250h**, **250i** may comprise a perimeter portion **255d**, **255e**, **255f**, **255g**, **255h**, **255i** that is comprised of substantially straight line portions, thereby forming the polygonal shape of the extension portion **250d**, **250e**, **250f**, **250g**, **250h**, **250i**. The perimeter portion **255d**, **255e**, **255f**, **255g**, **255h**, **255i** of the extension portion **250d**, **250e**, **250f**, **250g**, **250h**, **250i** forms part of the perimeter **203d**, **203e**, **203f**, **203g**, **203h**, **203i** of the plate structure **200d**, **200e**, **200f**, **200g**, **200h**, **200i**.

[0112] In a non-limiting embodiment, the perimeter portion **255d**, **255e**, **255f**, **255g**, **255h**, **255i** of the extension portion **250d**, **250e**, **250f**, **250g**, **250h**, **250i** may form a portion of a rectangle, square, or triangle. Referring to FIG. **18D** in particular, the extension portion **250g** may comprise a rectangular portion and a triangular tip **256g** terminating at an apex **257g**, whereby the apex **257g** coincides with the distal end **209g** of the treatment device **1g**. Although not shown, the perimeter portion **255d**, **255e**, **255f**, **255g**, **255h**, **255i** of the extension portion **250d**, **250e**, **250f**, **250g**, **250h**, **250i** may be curved or non-polygonal. In other embodiments, the distal end **209d**, **209e**, **209f**, **209h**, and **209i** may comprise a perimeter portion **255d**, **255e**, **255f**, **255h**, **255i** that is formed from a straight line.

[0113] In a non-limiting embodiment, the treatment device **1d-1i**, may comprise a main body portion **240d**, **240e**, **240f**, **240g**, **240h**, **240i** comprising a perimeter portion **245d**, **245e**, **245f**, **245g**, **245h**, **245i**. The perimeter portion **245d**, **245e**, **245f**, **245g**, **245h**, **245i** of the main body portion **240d**, **240e**, **240f**, **240g**, **240h**, **240i** forms part of the perimeter **203d**, **203e**, **203f**, **203g**, **203h**, **203i** of the plate structure **200d**, **200e**, **200f**, **200g**, **200h**, **200i**.

[0114] The perimeter portion **245d**, **245e**, **245f**, **245g**, **245h**, **245i** of the main body portion **240d**, **240e**, **240f**, **240g**, **240h**, **240i** intersects the perimeter portion **255d**, **255e**, **255f**, **255g**, **255h**, **255i** of the extension portion **250d**, **250e**, **250f**, **250g**, **250h**, **250i**.

[0115] In a non-limiting embodiment, the perimeter portion **245d**, **245e**, **245f**, **245g**, **245h**, **245i** of the main body portion **240d**, **240e**, **240f**, **240g**, **240h**, **240i** may be curved or non-polygonal in

shape. Referring to FIG. 18C in particular, the perimeter portion **245f**, **245g** of the main body portion **240f**, **240g** may comprise both straight segments and a curved segment, whereby the straight segments intersect with the perimeter portion **255f**, **255g** of the extension portion **250f**, **250g**. The proximal end **208d**, **208e**, **208f**, **208g**, **208h**, and **208i** may comprise a perimeter portion **245d**, **245e**, **245f**, **245h**, **245i** that is formed from a curved line.

[0116] The curved shape of the perimeter portion **245d**, **245e**, **245f**, **245g**, **245h**, **245i** of the main body portion **240d**, **240e**, **240f**, **240g**, **240h**, **240i** may be perfectly circular or ovular.

[0117] Referring now to FIG. 18F, the treatment device **1i** may have a main-body portion **240i** comprising a multi-lobed geometry. Specifically, the main body portion **240i** may comprise two or more lobes **246i** extending outward and forming part of the perimeter portion **245i** of the main body portion **240i**. Each lobe **246i** may comprise a portion of a circular shape—i.e., a portion of a circle, a portion of an oval. Each lobe may be a symmetrical shape or asymmetrical shape. Each of the lobes **246i** may be oriented symmetrically about a central point **249i** on the main body portion **240i**.

[0118] In a non-limiting example, the multi-lobed geometry of the main-body portion **240i** may be a trilobed geometry. The multi-lobed geometry may increase the surface area of the treatment device **1i** while avoiding the eye muscles, such that two lobes are in front of the eye muscles and the third lobe extends to the back of the eye, in between the eye muscles. Such increased surface may be advantageous for fluid absorption in lowering intraocular pressure. According to the embodiments where the multi-lobed geometry is trilobed, the main-body portion **240i** may have a generally triangular shape—whereby the corners may be rounded.

[0119] Referring now to FIGS. 9 and 10, a treatment device **1001** is illustrated in accordance with another embodiment of the present invention. The device **1001** is similar to the device **1** except as described herein below. The description of the device **1** and **1d-1i** above generally applies to the device **1001** described below except with regard to the differences specifically noted below. A similar numbering scheme will be used for the device **1001** as with the devices **1**, **1d-1i** except that a 1000-series number will be used.

[0120] The device **1001** may comprise a main body portion **1240**, an extension portion **1250**, and further comprise a barb portion **1260**. The barb portion **1260** may comprise a proximal end **1261** that is opposite a distal end **1262**. The proximal end **1261** of the barb portion **1260** may extend from the distal end **1252** of the extension portion **1240**. According to this embodiment, the distal end **1262** of the barb portion **1260** may overlap with the distal end **1209** of the plate structure **1200**. The longitudinal axis A-A may intersect both the proximal end **1261** and the distal end **1262** of the barb portion **1260**.

[0121] The barb portion **1260** may comprise a first major surface **1263** that is opposite a second major surface **1264**. The first major exposed surface **1201** of the plate structure **1200** may comprise the first major surface **1263** of the barb portion **1260**. The second major exposed surface **1202** of the plate structure **1200** may comprise the second major surface **1264** of the barb portion **1260**.

[0122] The barb portion **1260** may extend a barb length L.sub.B that spans the distance from the proximal end **1261** to the distal end **1262** of the barb portion **1260**. The barb length L.sub.B may range from about 1 mm to about 3 mm—including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between. In a preferred embodiment, the barb length L.sub.B may be about 2 mm.

[0123] The barb portion **1260** may have a maximum barb width W.sub.B that as measured by the maximum distance spanning the direction extending normal to the longitudinal axis A-A. The maximum barb width W.sub.B may range from about 1.0 mm to about 54.0 mm—including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between. In a preferred embodiment, the maximum barb width W.sub.B may be about 3.6 mm.

[0124] The maximum barb width W.sub.B may be greater than the extension width W.sub.E. In some embodiments, a ratio of the maximum barb width W.sub.B to the extension width W.sub.E may range from about 1.01:1 to about 3:1—including all ratios and sub-ranges there-between. In

some embodiments, the ratio of the barb width $W_{sub.B}$ to the extension width $W_{sub.E}$ may range from about 1.1:1 to about 2:1—including all ratios and sub-ranges there-between. In a preferred embodiment, the ratio of the barb width $W_{sub.B}$ to the extension width $W_{sub.E}$ may be about 1.4:1.

[0125] The first major surface **1263** of the barb portion **1260** may be substantially coplanar with the first major surface **1253** of the extension portion **1250**. The second major surface **1264** of the barb portion **1260** may be substantially coplanar with the second major surface **1254** of the extension portion **1250**.

[0126] The barb portion **1260** may have a height, as measured by the distance between the first and second major surfaces **1263**, **1264** of the barb portion **1260**, that is substantially equal to the first height $H_{sub.1}$ of the plate structure **1200**. The barb portion **1260** may comprise a triangular configuration comprising an apex point **1265**. The apex point **1265** may overlap with the distal end **1209** of the plate structure **1200**.

[0127] Referring now to FIGS. **11**, **12**, and **14**, the treatment device **1001** provides such fluid pathway for excess fluid to exit the eye **900**. Specifically, the treatment device **1** may be implanted onto the eye **900** such that it creates a fluid pathway from the anterior chamber **990** to the exterior of the sclera **913** to form a bleb. Once on the exterior surface of the sclera **913**, the excess fluid can be carried away from the eye **900** by absorption into surrounding tissue in the subject.

[0128] In particular, the treatment device **1001** may be implanted onto the eye **900** such that the plate structure **1200** is located between the sclera **913** and conjunctiva **950** tissue. The barb portion **1260** may extend from the extension portion **1250** through the sclera **913** and into the anterior chamber **990** of the eye **900** such that the distal end **1209** of the plate structure **200** is located within the anterior chamber **990**.

[0129] Referring now to FIG. **13**, a portion of the sclera **913** may be cut to form a slit **914** and that the barb portion **1260** may be inserted through the slit **914**, thereby anchoring the device **1** to the sclera **913**. The slit **913** may have a width substantially equal to the extension portion width W_E such that the barb portion **1260** and main body portion **1240** abut sclera tissue **913** surrounding the slit **914** and the extension portion **1250** is anchored inside of the slit beneath sclera tissue **913**.

Implanting the device **1001** according to this embodiment may be performed by temporarily deforming the barb portion **1260** such that it has a reduced barb width $W_{sub.B}$ that is equal to or less than the width of the slit **914**, allowing the barb portion **1260** to enter the slit **914**. Once past the slit **914**, the barb portion **1260** can then un-deform such that the barb portion **1260** has the barb width $W_{sub.B}$ in an undeformed state.

[0130] Referring now to FIGS. **15-17**, a treatment device **2001** is illustrated in accordance with another embodiment of the present invention. The device **2001** is similar to the devices **1**, **1001** except as described herein below. The description of the devices **1**, **1d-1i**, and **1001** above generally applies to the device **2001** described below except with regard to the differences specifically noted below. A similar numbering scheme will be used for the device **2001** as with the devices **1**, **1d-1i**, **1001** except that a 2000-series number will be used.

[0131] The device **2001** may comprise a plurality of plate structures **2200**. Although not limited to two plate structures, the foregoing discussion will refer to a first plate structure **2200a** and a second plate structure **2200b**. The description of the plate structure **200**, **1200** above generally applies to the first plate structure **2200a** and the second plate structure **2200b** described below except with regard to the differences specifically noted below. A similar numbering scheme will be used for the first plate structure **2200a** as with the plate structures **200**, **1200** except that a 2000-series number and an a-suffix will be used. A similar numbering scheme will be used for the second plate structure **2200b** as with the plate structures **200**, **1200** except that a 2000-series number and a b-suffix will be used.

[0132] The device **2001** may comprise the first plate structure **2200a** and the second plate structure **2200b** stacked together. As demonstrated in FIG. **17**, the second major surface **2202a** of the first

plate structure **2200a** may face the second major surface **2202b** of the second plate structure **2200b**. The second major surface **2202a** of the first plate structure **2200a** may be in direct contact with the second major surface **2202b** of the second plate structure **2200b**. In other embodiments, the device of this embodiment may comprise one or more intermediate layers positioned between the second major surface **2202a** of the first plate structure **2200a** and the second major surface **2202b** of the second plate structure **2200b**. Non-limiting examples of additional intermediate layers include adhesives, pharmacological layers, as well as additional multi-directional plates according to the present invention.

[0133] The second major surface **2202a** of the first plate structure **2200a** may face the second major surface **2202b** of the second plate structure **2200b** such that the open-channels **2232a** present on the second major surface **2202a** of the first plate structure **2200a** mirror the open channels **2232b** that are present on the second major surface **2202b** of the second plate structure **2200b**. The term “mirror” refers to the open-ends of each open-channels **2232a**, **2232b** completely overlapping each other such that, together, the combination of open-channels **2232a**, **2232b** of the first and second plate structures **2200a**, **2200b** form a collectively closed channel. In this manner, the treatment device **2001** may be a composite structure having insulating properties.

[0134] Although not pictured, in other embodiments, the second major surface **2202a** of the first plate structure **2200a** may face the second major surface **2202b** of the second plate structure **2200b** such that the open-channels **2232a** present on the second major surface **2202a** of the first plate structure **2200a** are horizontally offset from the open channels **2232b** that are present on the second major surface **2202b** of the second plate structure **2200b**. The term “horizontally offset” refers to the open-ends of each open-channels **2232a**, **2232b** either only partially overlapping or the open-ends of each open-channels **2232a**, **2232b** not overlapping at all.

[0135] Although not pictured, other embodiments provide that the second major surface **2202a** of the first plate structure **2200a** may face the first major surface **2201b** of the second plate structure **2200b** such that the open-channels **2232a** present on the second major surface **2202a** of the first plate structure **2200a** face the open cells **2228b** that are present on the first major surface **2201b** of the second plate structure **2200b**. In other embodiments, the first major surface **2201a** of the first plate structure **2200a** may face the second major surface **2202b** of the second plate structure **2200b** such that the open-cells **2228a** present on the first major surface **2201a** of the first plate structure **2200a** face the open channels **2232b** that are present on the second major surface **2202b** of the second plate structure **2200b**.

[0136] Although not pictured, in other embodiments, the first major surface **2201a** of the first plate structure **2200a** may face the first major surface **2201b** of the second plate structure **2200b** such that the open-cells **2228a** present on the first major surface **2201a** of the first plate structure **2200a** mirror the open-cells **2228b** that are present on the first major surface **2201b** of the second plate structure **2200b**. The term “mirror” refers to the open-cells **2228a**, **2228b** completely overlapping each other such that, together, the combination of open-cells **2228a**, **2228b** of the first and second plate structures **2200a**, **2200b** form a collectively closed cell. In this manner, the treatment device **2001** may be a composite structure having insulating properties.

[0137] Although not pictured, in other embodiments, the first major surface **2201a** of the first plate structure **2200a** may face the first major surface **2201b** of the second plate structure **2200b** such that the open-cells **2228a** present on the first major surface **2201a** of the first plate structure **2200a** are horizontally offset from the open-cells **2228b** that are present on the first major surface **2201b** of the second plate structure **2200b**. The term “horizontally offset” refers to the open-ends of each open-cell **222a**, **2228b** either only partially overlap or do not overlap at all.

[0138] The device **2001** according to this embodiment may be formed by manufacturing each of the first and second plate structures **2200a**, **2200b** separately followed by manually stacking the first and second plate structures **2200a**, **2200b** together. Alternatively, two or more plates structures can be fabricated in a pre-stacked arrangement. The device **2001** according to this embodiment

may be formed by photolithographic or etching process that forms the stacked plate structure. [0139] Referring now to FIG. 19, a treatment device **3001** is illustrated in accordance with another embodiment of the present invention. The device **3001** is similar to the devices **1**, **1d-1i**, **1001**, **2001** except as described herein below. The description of the devices **1**, **1d-1i**, **1001**, **2001** above generally applies to the device **3001** described below except with regard to the differences specifically noted below. A similar numbering scheme will be used for the device **3001** as with the devices **1**, **1d-1i**, **1001**, **2001** except that a 3000-series number will be used.

[0140] The treatment device **3001** may comprise a plate structure **3200** and a penetrating element **3100**. The penetrating element **3100** and the plate structure **3200** may be provided as separate components, whereby the penetrating element **3100** is coupled to the plate structure **3200**. The penetrating element **3100** and the plate structure **3200** may be coupled together by any suitable means, such as but not limited to adhesive, fastener, and the like. Non-limiting examples of fasteners include miniature anchors, straps, buckles, tape, or any other restraints. Non-limiting examples of adhesives include cyanoacrylates, epoxy resins, thermosets, thermoplastics, elastomers, PDMS, epoxy, silicone-based, polyurethanes, or the like.

[0141] The penetrating element **3100** may comprise an outer surface and an inner surface. The penetrating element may be flexible and comprise an elongated body **3110** that extends along a longitudinal axis. The elongated body **3110** may comprise a first end **3120** (also referred to as “distal end”) opposite a second end **3130** (also referred to as “proximal end”), whereby the longitudinal axis intersects both the first end **3120** and the second end **3130** of the elongated body **3110**. The elongated body **3110** may extend a length $L_{sub.3}$ as measured from the first end **3120** to the second end **3130**, whereby the length $L_{sub.3}$ ranges from about 5 mm to about 32 mm—including all lengths and sub-ranges there-between.

[0142] The elongated body **3110** may comprise an outer surface and an inner surface, whereby the inner surface defines a passageway **3140** (also referred to herein as “lumen passageway”) that extends through the elongated body **3110** along the longitudinal axis. The inner surface may be continuous and form a circular cross-section. The passageway **3140** may intersect the first end **3120** the elongated body **3110**. The passageway **3140** may intersect the second end **3130** the elongated body **3110**. The inner surface of the elongated body **3110** may form an open conduit that is the passageway **3140** that provides fluid communication between the first end **3120** and the second end **3130** of the elongated body **3110**. The outer surface of the penetrating element **3100** may comprise the outer surface of the elongated body **3110**.

[0143] In some embodiments a coating may be applied to the inner surface of the elongated body **3110** such that the inner surface of the penetrating element comprises the coating. In such embodiments, the coating may form the surfaces that define the lumen passageway **3140**. In some embodiments a coating may be applied to the outer surface of the elongated body **3110** such that the outer surface of the penetrating element **3100** comprises the coating.

[0144] The outer surface of the elongated body **3110** may circumscribe the inner surface of the elongated body **3110**, whereby both the inner surface and the outer surface are oriented about the longitudinal axis. The outer surface and the inner surface of the elongated body **3110** may be oriented concentrically about the longitudinal axis.

[0145] The elongated body **3110** may form a hollow cylindrical shape. The passageway **3140** may have an inner diameter as measured in a direction radially from the longitudinal axis to the inner surface of the penetrating element **3100**. The inner diameter of the passageway **3140** may range from about 0.01 mm to about 5 mm—including all diameters and sub-ranges there-between. In a preferred embodiment, the inner diameter of the passageway **3140** may be less than about 1 mm. In a non-limiting example, the inner diameter of the passageway **3140** may be 0.01 mm, 0.05 mm, 0.11 mm, 0.15 mm, 0.2 mm, 0.25 mm, 0.3 mm, 0.35 mm, 0.4 mm, 0.45 mm, 0.5 mm, 0.55 mm, 0.6 mm, 0.65 mm, 0.7 mm, 0.75 mm, 0.8 mm, 0.85 mm, 0.9 mm, 0.95 mm, 1 mm, 2 mm, 3 mm, 4 mm, and 5 mm.

[0146] The elongated body **3110** may have an outer diameter as measured in a direction radially from the longitudinal axis. The outer diameter is the distance spanning opposite portions of the outer surface **3111** of the elongated body **3110**. The outer diameter may be equal to about 101% to about 150% of the inner diameter—including all percentages and sub-ranges there-between. Stated otherwise, the inner diameter of the passageway **3140** is less than the outer diameter of the passageway **3140**.

[0147] The penetrating element **3100**—including the elongated body **3110**—may be formed from a polymeric material. In some embodiments, the elongated body **3110** may be a polymer tube having a lumen. As embodied herein, the polymer may be a biocompatible polymer. The biocompatible polymer may be an organic polymer, an inorganic polymer, or blends thereof. Non-limiting examples of biocompatible polymer include silicone rubber, polyethylene, polypropylene, poly(methyl methacrylate) (PMMA), poly(tetrafluoroethylene) (PTFE), polystyrene, polyethylcyanoacrylate, poly(vinyl chloride) (PVC), polyether ether ketone (PEEK), polyether sulfone (PES), polymer gels and combinations thereof. In certain embodiments, the biocompatible polymer can include a single type of polymer or a combination of different polymers, e.g., as a polymer blend and/or copolymer. In certain embodiments, the polymeric matrix can be one or more flexible polymers and/or one or more solid polymers.

[0148] Although not shown, the penetrating element **3100** may further comprise at least one perforation on the elongated body **3110**. Specifically, the perforation may extend outward radially from the longitudinal axis. The perforations may extend continuously from inner surface of the elongated body **3110** to the outer surface of the elongated body **3110**. The perforations provide a passageway that creates fluid communication between the inner surface and the outer surface of the elongated body **3110**. The perforations may extend continuously from inner surface of the penetrating element **3100** to the outer surface of the penetrating element **3100**. The perforations provide a passageway that creates fluid communication between the inner surface of the penetrating element **3100** and the outer surface of the penetrating element **3100**.

[0149] The perforations may be present on the penetrating element **3100** in a location that is adjacent to the first end **3120** of the elongated body **3110**. The perforations may be present on the penetrating element **3100** in a location that is adjacent to the second end **3130** of the elongated body **3110**. The perforations may increase the flow rate of fluid (e.g., aqueous humour) through the penetrating element **3100** via the passageway **3140**.

[0150] According to some embodiments of the present invention, the treatment device **3001** may comprise the penetrating element **3100** coupled to the plate structure **3200**. Specifically, at least a portion of the outer surface of the penetrating element **3100** may directly contact the first major exposed surface **3201** of the plate structure **3200**. Direct contact may be maintained by thermal bonding or welding together the two surfaces.

[0151] In other embodiments, at least a portion of the outer surface of the penetrating element **3100** may indirectly contact the first major exposed surface **3201** of the plate structure **3200** whereby the indirect contact is the result of a coupling element being present between the outer surface of the penetrating element **3100** and the first major exposed surface **3201** of the plate structure **3200**. Non-limiting examples of a coupling element may include adhesive or separate fastener, such as one or more anchors (e.g., a silicon anchor formed on the multi-directional plate), straps, buckles, elastic bands, tape, or any other suitable securing features. As described further herein, the penetrating element **3100** may also be coupled to the plate structure by geometric modifications aimed at securing the tubing to the plate.

[0152] When the penetrating element **3100** is coupled to the plate structure **3200**, the penetrating element **3100** may overlay at least a portion of the first major exposed surface **3201** of the plate structure **3200** such that the portion of the first major exposed surface **3201** of the plate structure **3200** is no longer exposed (i.e., the portion is covered by the penetrating element **3100**). In such configuration, at least one open-cell present on the first topography may be closed by the outer

surface of the penetrating element **3100**.

[0153] Although not shown, other embodiments include that the penetrating element **3100** may be coupled to the plate structure **3200** such that the penetrating element **3100** may overlay at least a portion of the second major exposed surface **3202** of the plate structure **3200** such that the portion of the second major exposed surface **3202** of the plate structure **3200** is no longer exposed (i.e., the portion is covered by the penetrating element **3100**). In such configuration, at least one open-channel present on the second topography may be closed by the outer surface of the penetrating element **3100**.

[0154] The penetrating element **3100** may be positioned relative to the plate structure **3200** such that the longitudinal axis of the elongated body **3110** is oriented substantially orthogonal to the cell axis A-A of the plate structure **3200**. In other embodiments, the penetrating element **3100** may be positioned relative to the plate structure **3200** such that the longitudinal axis A-A of the elongated body **3110** is oriented oblique to the cell axis A-A of the plate structure **3200**.

[0155] The side surface **3203** of the plate structure **3200** may form a perimeter of the first major exposed surface **3201** of the plate structure **3200**—similarly, the side exposed surface **3203** forms a perimeter of the second major exposed surface **3202** of the plate structure **3200**.

[0156] The following discussion is made in reference to the first major exposed surface **3201** but also applies to the second major exposed surface **3202**. The first major exposed surface **3201** of the plate structure **3200** comprises a perimeter region P.sub.R that is adjacent to the perimeter formed by the side surface **3203**. The first major exposed surface **3201** of the plate structure **3200** comprises a central region C.sub.R that is circumscribed by the perimeter region P.sub.R.

[0157] The perimeter of the plate structure **3200** may form a symmetrical or asymmetrical boundary. In either embodiment, the plate structure **3200** may be generally centered about a central point **3208**. The perimeter region P.sub.R and the central region C.sub.R may be concentric about the central point **208**. In a non-limiting embodiment, the transition between the perimeter region P.sub.R and the central region C.sub.R may be delineated by the dotted boundary **3209** between the central region C.sub.R and the perimeter region P.sub.R.

[0158] The boundary **3209** may be inset from the perimeter of the plate structure **3200** by a perimeter distance D.sub.P—whereby the perimeter distance D.sub.P is a non-zero value. The boundary **3209** may conform to the geometry of the perimeter; however, the present invention does not limit the shape of the dotted boundary **3209** to any particular shape (e.g., polygon, circle, ellipsis, non-geometric shapes, etc.).

[0159] The first major exposed surface **3201** of the plate structure **3200** may have a first surface area. The perimeter distance D_p may be equal to a value such that the perimeter region P.sub.R is equal to about 1% to about 50% of the first surface area. The perimeter distance D_p may be equal to a value such that the central region C.sub.R may be equal about 50% to about 99% of the first surface area.

[0160] The treatment device **1** may comprise the penetrating element **3100** such that the second end **3130** of the elongated body **3110** lies within the perimeter region P.sub.R and the first end **3120** extends beyond the perimeter of the first major exposed surface **3201** of the plate structure **200**. Stated otherwise, as shown in FIG. **19**, the penetrating element **3100** may not overlay the central region C.sub.R of the plate structure **3200**. In such embodiments, the amount of overlap between the penetrating element **3100** and the first major exposed surface **3201** of the plate structure **3200** may be equal to 1% to about 99% of the perimeter distance D.sub.P—including all amounts and sub-ranges there-between.

[0161] According to this embodiment, the treatment device **3001** may be implanted onto the eye **900** such that the plate structure **3200** is located between the sclera **913** and conjunctiva **950** tissue. The penetrating element **3100** may extend from the plate structure **3200** through the sclera **913** and into the anterior chamber **990** of the eye **900** such that the first end **3120** of the penetrating element **3100** is located within the anterior chamber **990**. Under this configuration, the penetrating element

3100 may function as a passageway to deliver excess fluid from anterior cavity to the plate structure **3200**, which functions as an external reservoir for the excess fluid until it is absorbed by the surrounding tissue of the subject.

[0162] According to the embodiments where the plate structure **3200** comprises a multi-lobed geometry is trilobed, the plate structure **3200** may have a generally triangular shape whereby the corners may be rounded. In such embodiment, the penetrating element **3100** may overlay the perimeter region PR (and optionally, the central region CR) such that the penetrating element **3100** does not intersect any of the lobes.

[0163] In such configuration, the elongated body **3110** of the penetrating element **3100** may intersect the perimeter **3203** of the plate structure **3200** and be located between the first and second lobe without intersecting the third lobe. In other embodiments, the elongated body **3110** of the penetrating element **3100** may intersect the perimeter **3203** of the plate structure **3200** and be located between the first and third lobe without intersecting the second lobe. In other embodiments, the elongated body **3110** of the penetrating element **3100** may intersect the perimeter **3203** of the plate structure **3200** and be located between the second and third lobe without intersecting the first lobe.

[0164] Referring now to FIGS. **21** and **22**, a treatment device **4001** is illustrated in accordance with another embodiment of the present invention. The treatment device **4001** is similar to the treatment devices **1**, **1d-1i**, **2001**, **3001**, except as described herein below. The description of the treatment devices **1**, **1d-1i**, **2001**, **3001**, above generally applies to the treatment device **4001** described below except with regard to the differences specifically noted below. A similar numbering scheme will be used for the treatment device **4001** as with the treatment devices **1**, **1d-1i**, **2001**, **3001**, except that a 4000-series of numbering will be used.

[0165] According to this embodiment, the treatment device **4001** may comprise a penetrating element **4100** that forms a protuberance from at least one of the major surfaces **4201**, **4202** of the plate structure **4200**. The penetrating element **4200** according this embodiment may be coupled to or, alternatively, integrally formed with the plate structure **4200**. In such embodiments, the protuberance component **4100** may be formed from a material that is the same material used to form the plate structure **4200**. In other embodiments, the penetrating element **4200** may be the same general class of material used to form the plate structure **4200** (e.g., ceramic material) while each specific material may be different. In a non-limiting example, the plate structure **4200** and the penetrating element **4200** may both be formed from a ceramic material, wherein the multi-directional plate is formed from a first ceramic material (e.g., alumina) and the penetrating element **4200** is formed of a second ceramic material (e.g., silica), the first and second ceramic materials being different.

[0166] The penetrating element **4200** may extend along a longitudinal axis that is substantially orthogonal to the first and second major exposed surfaces **4201**, **4202** of the plate structure **4200**. The penetrating element **4200** may extend from a proximal end **4330** to a distal end **4320**, whereby the proximal end **4330** is coupled to or integrally formed with the plate structure **4200**.

[0167] The penetrating element **4300** may function as an integrally formed flow channel or pathway through or along the plate structure **4200**. A flow channel **4340** may extend along the longitudinal axis such that it is oriented orthogonal to the first and second major exposed surfaces **4201**, **4202** of the plate structure **4200**. Alternatively, the outer surface of the penetrating element **4300** may create a pathway for intraocular fluid to flow along.

[0168] In other embodiments, the treatment device **1** of the present invention may be a material suitable for implantation into other regions of the eye **900** including but not limited to the cornea **910**, the retina **941**, the lens **930**—as well as a stabilizing structure between various eye tissues, and a structure for directing fluid, chemicals, and/or signals between arts of the eye. Additional; spaces that may be suitable for implantation with the treatment device **1** of the present invention include uveoscleral outflow pathway, Schlemm's canal and collector channels, trabecular meshwork, and

suprachoroidal space. In certain embodiments, more than one treatment device **1** can be implanted into one or multiple quadrants of the eye **900**.

EXAMPLES

[0169] This Example illustrates the use of the drainage device to lower intraocular pressure and the tolerability of the device when implanted beneath the conjunctiva in New Zealand White Rabbits. Materials and Methods

[0170] Fabrication of the drainage device: Honeycomb structures were designed and fabricated out of 53 nm-thick ALD alumina (Al.sub.2O.sub.3) and silica (SiO.sub.2). The honeycomb structures were fabricated in different geometries with lateral dimensions varying between 0.5 and 10 millimeters. Three clamping configurations have been used: cantilevers, doubly clamped beams, and rectangular plates clamped on all four sides.

[0171] The fabrication started with a double side polished Si wafer. SiN films with a thickness of 180 nm were deposited on both sides using PECVD. Honeycomb structures with a height of 10 μ m were patterned in silicon using photolithography and reactive ion etching (RIE). The back side was patterned via photolithography and the openings were obtained by RIE etching of SiN. The SiN mask was removed from the front side and the ALD layer was then deposited. For alumina deposition, trimethylaluminum (TMA) and water were used as precursors and two different temperatures, 150° C. and 250° C., were used. The deposition rates were measured using an ellipsometer to be 0.91 Å/cycle at 150° C. and 1.18 Å/cycle at 250° C.

[0172] In order to pattern the ALD layer, a thick layer of SPR **220** resist was spin-coated on the structure. The thickness of the resist was measured to be 14 μ m. After the spin coating and soft baking at 105° C. the wafer was cooled down slowly to make sure the photoresist did not crack. After photolithography, inductively coupled plasma etching (ICP) with a BC13-based chemistry process was used to pattern the alumina ALD layer. In contrast, RIE was used to pattern the silica ALD layer. Anisotropic KOH etching was next. Before placing the wafer in KOH, the top surface was covered with ProTek to prevent the ALD layer from being etched in the KOH solution. A silicon etching rate of 75 μ m/hour was measured at 80° C. in the 30% KOH solution. By accurately timing the KOH etching process, it was possible to stop the process 20 μ m from the top surface. The exact depth was measured using a Zygo profilometer. After that, the ProTek layer was removed and oxygen plasma was performed to make sure the surface of the wafer was completely clean and without any polymer residue. In some embodiments, as an alternative to KOH etching, the silicon substrate can be partially removed using a laser micromachining system such as IPG Photonics IX-280-DSF. XeF.sub.2 etching was used for the final release of the structure. Approximately 100 cycles (30 sec each) of XeF.sub.2 etching with a ratio of 3.2:2 (XeF.sub.2:N.sub.2) was required for the complete release of the structures. A silicon tubing was coupled to the plate structure through a silicon anchor. The inner diameter of tubing was 0.5 mm. Prior to the surgery, a geometry of the plate structure was modified and the tubing was primed with balanced salt solution to obtain the desired length and shape.

[0173] Surgical Methods: Three experimentally naive New Zealand White rabbits (1 male and 2 females), approximately 5 months old and weighing 2.8 to 3.3 kilograms for males and females at the outset of the study were assigned to treatment groups as shown in the table 1 below.

TABLE-US-00001
TABLE 1
Number of Animals
GROUP Left Eye Right Eye Male Female
1. Test Insertion between the Sham incision in 1 2 Article sclera and the the conjunctiva conjunctiva via a conjunctival incision

[0174] To implant the treatment device, each rabbit was anesthetized with a combination of Ketamine (40 mg/kg) and Xylazine (4 mg/kg) subcutaneously. Anesthetics were supplemented as needed. All drug usage was documented in the raw data. A few drops of 1% proparacaine (topical anesthesia) were placed in each eye at this time as well. Once anesthetized, the rabbit was placed in lateral recumbency and the area surrounding the eye prepped with a Swapstick containing 10% Providone-iodine. The eye was then rinsed with 0.9% sterile saline and another few drops of

proparacaine given. A sterile drape was placed over the rabbit allowing exposure of the eye. Sterile instruments (steam autoclaved prior to first procedure and then chemically sterilized in chlorhexidine solution and rinsed with sterile water/saline between animals). Sterile gloves were worn.

[0175] The eyelid was kept open manually or with an eyelid speculum for the procedure. The eye was rotated medially using Colibri forceps and a small incision made in the conjunctiva lateral to the iris. A subconjunctival pocket was created ventrally and the treatment device placed within. Upon placement, the eye was allowed to rotate back to normal position and placement of the treatment device was observed to assure it is lying well within the subconjunctival pocket. The rabbit was then rotated to the other side and a sham procedure performed similarly on the contralateral eye, with no treatment device or other material implanted. Sterile ophthalmic ointment was placed on both eyes during the recovery period.

[0176] Observations and Measurements: The treatment device was implanted into the eye of the subjects on Day 1 via a conjunctival incision between the sclera and the conjunctiva. Mortality and clinical observations were evaluated daily. Ocular irritation scores were recorded prior to dose on Day 1, once daily on Days 2-5, Day 12, and Day 19. Body weights were recorded weekly. Food consumption was recorded daily. All animals were sacrificed on Day 21. The eyes with optic nerve for all animals were harvested at necropsy and evaluated microscopically.

[0177] Histological analysis: The animals were sacrificed with an overdose of an intravenous barbiturate on Day 21. All animals were necropsied. The eyes with optic nerve were collected and immediately fixed in Davidson's fixative for 24-48 hours. After the nerve specimens were dehydrated with increasing concentrations of ethanol (30-100%), the nerves were sectioned with a sharp razor blade. The sections were then embedded in paraffin in descending order and sectioned at 3 mm in thickness. The sections were stained with hematoxylin and eosin. Two sections (halves of the globe) with pupillary-optic disc orientation were trimmed from each eye, and two levels were microtomed per paraffin block, resulting in four slides per eye available for microphonic examination,

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

[0178] One male and two females New Zealand White rabbits were dosed once on Day 1 with the treatment device via a conjunctival incision between the sclera and the conjunctiva.

[0179] Mortality/Morbidity: There were no early deaths during the study. All animals survived until their scheduled sacrifice on Day 21.

[0180] Clinical Observations: On Day 1, mild to moderately decreased behavioral activity was noted post-surgery, and all animals had closed or partially closed eyes at 2-4 hours post-dose. These findings were considered test article unrelated and were secondary to the anesthesia and surgical procedures. All animals appeared normal on study days 2-21, and no clinical signs were noted.

[0181] Ocular Observations: The eyes of all animals (left and right) had ocular Draize scores of 0 prior to dosing on Day 1. Minimal overall Draize scores were recorded on study Days 2 and 3. Scores were noted in both, the left and right eye (drainage device implant and sham procedure, respectively). By Day 4, no ocular scores were noted. Table 2 below, summarizes the overall ocular Draize scores recorded during the study.

TABLE-US-00002

TABLE 2 Overall Ocular Draize Score			Left Eye	Right Eye	Animal #s	Animal #s
1414	1413	1416	1414	1413	1416	Study Day 1
0	0	0	0	0	0	Study Day 2
0	2	2	0	2	0	Study Day 3
0	2	0	0	2	0	Study Day 4
0	0	0	0	0	0	Study Day 5
0	0	0	0	0	0	Study Day 12
0	0	0	0	0	0	Study Day 19
0	0	0	0	0	0	

[0182] Body weight: No apparent test article-related effects on body weight or body weight gains were noted.

[0183] Food consumption: There were no test article-related effects on food consumption. The animals ate all their food on essentially all days.

Postmortem Observations

[0184] Gross necropsy findings: No gross necropsy findings were noted at scheduled sacrifice on Day 21.

[0185] Histopathology: The treatment device was not visible microscopically in any animal. A focal scleral [defect] ← [or “alteration”, since “defect” might imply a problem]] was noted near the limbus in several eyes, consisting of an elevation and separation of conjunctiva and superficial collagen fibers from the deeper collagen fibers of the sclera, creating an empty space. Aside from fragmentation of collagen, no notable tissue reaction was evident. While a defect of minimal (Grade 1) severity was noted in two control (right) eyes, defects of mild (Grade 2) to moderate (Grade 3) severity were evident in two out of three treated (left) eyes, rising suspicion that the tissue defects in the eyes receiving the treatment device could at least in part represent implant sites in which the implant fragmented or washed out during processing. Conjunctival hyperplasia, lymphoplasmacytic infiltrate, and/or fibrosis of minimal severity were noted near the limbus in right and left eyes of all three animals. These lesions can be explained as spontaneous background findings and/or associated with surgical manipulation.

[0186] In summary, no test related clinical observations, effects on body weight or body weight gains, or effects on food consumption were noted. Post-surgery, overall Draize scores were minimal and all eyes appeared normal by Day 4. No gross necropsy findings were noted at scheduled sacrifice on Day 21. The treatment device was not visible after tissue processing, and no tissue reaction was noted at the implant site. In conclusion, the treatment device when implanted beneath the conjunctiva in New Zealand White rabbits was well tolerated.

[0187] It will be understood that the foregoing only demonstrates the tolerability of a treatment device when implanted into the eye and is only illustrative of the principles of the present disclosure, and that various modifications can be made by those skilled in the art without departing from the scope and spirit of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A device for lowering intraocular pressure, the device comprising: a continuous plate structure that enables aqueous humor to flow from a first end to a second end, the continuous plate structure comprising: a first exposed surface opposite a second exposed surface, the first exposed surface including a plurality of open cells, each of the plurality of open cells including a cell floor, at least one cell wall and an open-end located opposite the respective cell floor, thereby forming an open volume between the respective cell wall and the respective cell floor accessible through the respective open-end; and a fluid pathway including a plurality of open channels formed into the second exposed surface, the plurality of open channels configured in an intersecting grid pattern extending from the first end to the second end, each of the plurality of open channels including a channel ceiling, at least one channel wall and an open-end located opposite the respective channel ceiling, thereby forming an open volume between the respective channel wall and the respective channel ceiling accessible through the respective open-end, wherein the continuous plate structure enables aqueous humor to flow along the fluid pathway, thereby reducing intraocular pressure within the eye, and wherein the first end of the continuous plate structure is inserted into an anterior chamber of the eye.
2. The device according to claim 1, wherein a thickness of the continuous plate structure ranges from 50 nm to 500 nm.
3. The device according to claim 1, wherein the continuous plate structure is flexible.
4. The device according to claim 1, wherein the continuous plate structure is formed from a ceramic material, Wherein the ceramic material is selected from the group consisting of alumina, silicon nitride, silica, hafnium oxide, titanium nitride, and titanium carbide.
5. The device according to claim 1, wherein the continuous plate structure extends along a longitudinal axis, the continuous plate structure further comprising: a main body portion having a

proximal end opposite a distal end, the main body portion having a first length as measured from a distance between the proximal end and the distal end of the main body portion; and an extension portion having a proximal end opposite a distal end, the extension portion having a second length as measured from a distance between the proximal end and the distal end of the extension portion, wherein the longitudinal axis intersects the proximal and distal ends of both the main body portion and the extension portion and the proximal end of the extension portion extends from the distal end of the main body portion.

6. The device according to claim 5, wherein a ratio of the first length to the second length ranges from 1:1 to 5:1.

7. The device according to claim 5, wherein the first length is greater than the second length.

8. The device according to claim 5, wherein the main body portion has a first width measured in a direction normal to the longitudinal axis, and the extension portion has a second width measured in a direction normal to the longitudinal axis.

9. The device according to claim 8, wherein the first width is greater than the second width.

10. The device according to claim 8, wherein a ratio of the first width to the second width ranges from 1.1:1 to 4:1.

11. The device according to claim 8, wherein the continuous plate structure further comprises a barb portion having a proximal end opposite a distal end, wherein the longitudinal axis intersects the proximal and distal ends of the barb portion and the proximal end of the barb portion extends from the distal end of the extension portion.

12. The device according to claim 1, wherein each of the plurality of open cells are isolated from each other.

13. A device for lowering intraocular pressure, the device comprising: a continuous plate structure that enables aqueous humor to flow from a first end to a second end, the first end having a maximum width that is narrower than a maximum width of the second end, the continuous plate structure comprising: an uppermost surface opposite a lowermost surface, the uppermost surface including a plurality of open cells; and a fluid pathway including a plurality of open channels formed into the lowermost surface, the plurality of open channels configured in an intersecting grid pattern extending from the first end to the second end, each of the plurality of open channels including a channel ceiling, at least one channel wall and an open-end located opposite the respective channel ceiling, thereby forming an open volume between the respective channel wall and the respective channel ceiling accessible through the respective open-end, wherein the continuous plate structure enables aqueous humor to flow along the fluid pathway, thereby reducing intraocular pressure within the eye, and wherein the first end of the continuous plate structure is inserted into an anterior chamber of the eye.

14. The device according to claim 13, wherein each of the plurality of open cells includes a cell floor, at least one cell wall, and an open-end located opposite the respective cell floor, thereby forming an open volume between the respective cell wall and the respective cell floor accessible through the respective open-end.

15. The device according to claim 13, wherein the continuous plate structure is flexible.

16. The device according to claim 13, wherein the continuous plate structure is formed from a ceramic material selected from the group consisting of alumina, silicon nitride, silica, hafnium oxide, titanium nitride, and titanium carbide.

17. The device according to claim 13, wherein the continuous plate structure further includes a penetrating element secured to the uppermost surface of the continuous plate structure, wherein the penetrating element is inserted into an anterior chamber of the eye.

18. The device according to claim 17, wherein the penetrating element comprises an elongated body with a first end and a second end, the elongated body extending between the first end of the elongated body and the second end of the elongated body, and wherein an internal channel extends from the first end of the elongated body to the second end of the elongated body creating an open

passageway through the elongated body.

19. The device according to claim 17, wherein the elongated body comprises an outer surface opposite an inner surface, and the inner surface forming a wall that defines the internal channel.

20. The device according to claim 17, wherein the penetrating element is formed from a polymeric material, wherein the polymeric material is selected from the group consisting of silicone rubber, polyethylene, polypropylene, poly(methyl methacrylate), poly(tetrafluoroethylene), polystyrene, polyethylcyanoacrylate, poly(vinyl chloride), polyether ether ketone, and polyether sulfone.
